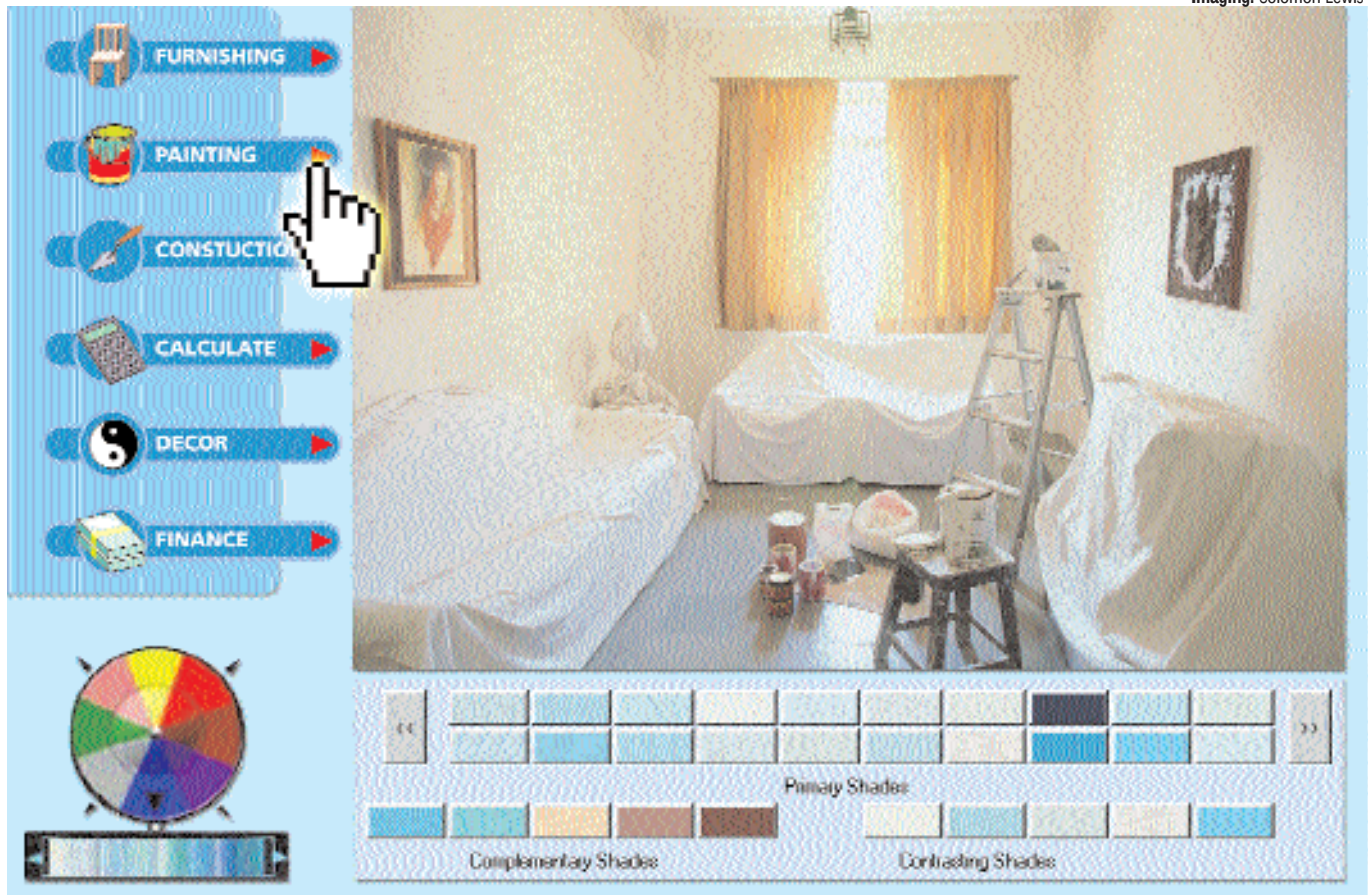




A Model Home

Quit juggling cans of paint, lugging furniture and dealing with decorators.

Remodel your home online

AVINA LOBO

The paint's peeling; the furniture's looking a bit worn. You feel like giving your home a complete makeover. The easy way out would be to hire an interior decorator to take care of everything (except for signing the cheque).

But if you prefer the do-it-yourself way and want to personally get involved with everything right down to purchasing the last brick, home building or remodelling can be very time consuming. You'll wear yourself out getting hold of contractors, painters and carpenters and before you know it, you'll be swamped with more bags of cement or cans of paint than you need and an empty pocket.

Wondering if there's an easier way to plan the building or remodelling of your home without having to rely on interior decorators and contractors for ideas and options?

Build offline, plan online

Building or remodelling a home is definitely an 'offline' task. You have to buy bricks, sand and

paint, and hire people to get it done. So what does the Net have to do with it?

Two very important aspects of every project are planning and research. Get this right and you'll end up saving a lot of money, time and energy. The Net gives you the opportunity to get all your research done online—from deciding the plan or layout of your home to finding out where you can buy building material in your city and planning the furniture arrangement and decor in your room. Moreover, it provides you with tools to help you stay in control of the entire process of remodelling, from scheduling to budgeting.

The first step obviously is to decide what you want—the built-up area, number of rooms and the plan or layout of your house or apartment. If you need a ready plan or are looking at layout ideas, head over to Lafarge-India (www.lafarge-india.com), which has around 20 plans for all kinds of apartments, whether it is a one-bedroom or a three-bedroom house. An enlarged sketch and a description accompany each plan. You'll also